

# **Cognitive Psychology**

PSY 2100 Sections 001, 090, and 290  
Spring 2025

**PSY2100-001 will be held T/Th 9:10am-10:30pm MST in M LI 1130**

Recordings of the live class will be uploaded to Canvas for students in PSY2100-090 and PSY2100-290 to watch asynchronously.

## **Syllabus**

### Contacts

Instructor: Dr. David Strayer [David.Strayer@utah.edu](mailto:David.Strayer@utah.edu)  
TA: Allie Geiger

### Office Hours

Dr. David Strayer: By appointment  
Allie Geiger: By appointment

### Materials

Textbook Title: Cognition  
Authors: Thomas A. Farmer and Margaret W. Matlin  
Publisher: Wiley  
Edition/Year: 10<sup>th</sup> edition, 2019  
ISBN-13: 978-1119491712  
Type: Required resource

### Course Description

This 3 credit course is an introduction to an information-processing analysis of cognition. It will touch on topics related to perception, attention, memory, language, decision making and problem solving.

### Grading

Grades will be based on three exams and participation in the class. *Note that you must receive a C or better for this course to count towards a major in Psychology.* Conversion of scores to letter grade is given below:

A 100-93 | A- 92-90 | B+ 89-87 | B 86-83 | B- 82-80 | C+ 79-77 | C 76-73 | C- 72-70 | D+ 69-67 | D 66-63 | D- 62-60 | E below 60

### Exams

Exams will consist of approximately 30 multiple choice and 1-2 essay questions. The exam will take place on Canvas. The exam will draw upon all material covered in lectures and in the assigned readings. Each exam grade will be computed using the following equation:

Exam score = Raw score / Highest class raw score \* 100

For example, if the exam had 100 points possible, the Highest Class Raw Score was 80, and your Raw Score was 60, your Exam Score would be 75% (i.e., 60/80). *Note that this grading procedure evaluates your performance relative to actual students in the class rather than to an arbitrary absolute standard. Also note that it is theoretically possible for everyone in the class to receive an A. The final exam is comprehensive and will include material covered throughout the course.*

### Make-up Exams

If you cannot take an exam at the regularly scheduled time, please note that I will NOT give make-up exams unless your absence falls within the university approved guidelines, which are described in their accommodations policy document on their website (<https://disability.utah.edu/students/accomodations-services.php#exam>)

If your absence falls within the university approved guidelines, you still MUST notify me in advance and receive my approval for a make-up exam.

### Important Dates

The last day to drop (delete) classes is Friday, January 17<sup>th</sup>.

The last day to withdraw from classes is Friday, February 28<sup>th</sup>.

#### Exam Dates

Exam 1: February 4<sup>h</sup>

Exam 2: March 6<sup>th</sup>

Exam 3: April 29<sup>h</sup>

### Changes in Course Procedures

As the instructor, I reserve the right to modify any part of the course (including the syllabus) at any time during the semester. Because of this, please remember to check the class site regularly for announcements and changes.

### Students with Disabilities

The University of Utah seeks to provide equal access to its programs, services and activities for people with disabilities. If you will need accommodations in this class, reasonable prior notice needs to be given to the instructor and to the Center for Disability Services, 162 Olpin Union Building, 581-5020 (V/TDD) to make arrangements for accommodations. All written information in this course can be made available in alternative format with prior notification.

### Incompletes

I follow the guidelines on incompletes provided by the university. To receive an incomplete, the student must: a) request it; b) receive approval from the instructor; c) have completed 80% of the material to be covered during the semester; and d) be passing the class at the time. No exceptions will be made.

### Academic Misconduct Policy

The Department of Psychology has a zero-tolerance policy for academic misconduct.

Academic misconduct includes cheating, plagiarizing, research misconduct, misrepresenting one's work, and inappropriately collaborating. This applies to any work students turn in for evaluation or course credit. Definitions can be found in the Student Code at <http://www.regulations.utah.edu/academics/6-400.html>.

If you are suspected of academic misconduct, the process proceeds according to the rules found in the Student Code, University Policy 6-400(V). If you are found responsible for misconduct, consequences range from failure on the assignment to dismissal from the program, consistent with both University and Psychology Department Policy.

#### University Safety Statement

The University of Utah values the safety of all campus community members. To report suspicious activity or to request a courtesy escort, call campus police at 801-585-COPS (801-585-2677). You will receive important emergency alerts and safety messages regarding campus safety via text message. For more information regarding safety and to view available training resources, including helpful videos, visit [safeu.utah.edu](http://safeu.utah.edu).

#### Learning Outcomes

This class satisfies the learning outcomes articulated by APA. In this class you will:

- Understand psychology as a science of human behavior, including cognition and emotions, as well as to gain an understanding of human behavior in broad perspective, including physiological and socio-cultural factors that affect human behavior.
- Understand sub-fields within psychology (developmental, personality, social, cognitive, neuroscience, health, clinical).
- Understand the methods used in psychological research.
- Understand the critical role of theory in psychological research.
- Understand some of the basic applications of psychology to real-world problems.
- Write effectively about psychological issues, making well-organized arguments supported by relevant evidence.

#### Addressing Sexual Misconduct

Title IX makes it clear that violence and harassment based on sex and gender (which includes sexual orientation and gender identity/expression) is a civil rights offense subject to the same kinds of accountability and the same kinds of support applied to offenses against other protected categories such as race, national origin, color, religion, age, status as a person with a disability, veteran's status or genetic information. If you or someone you know has been harassed or assaulted, you are encouraged to report it to the Title IX Coordinator in the Office of Equal Opportunity and Affirmative Action, 135 Park Building, 801-581-8365, or the Office of the Dean of Students, 270 Union Building, 801-581-7066. For support and confidential consultation, contact the Center for Student Wellness, 426 SSB, 801-581-7776. To report to the police, contact the Department of Public Safety, 801-585-2677(COPS).

| <u>Dates</u> | <u>Lectures</u>                     | <u>Chapters/Readings</u>     |
|--------------|-------------------------------------|------------------------------|
| January 7    | Introduction                        | Chapters 1&2                 |
| January 9    | The Visual System                   |                              |
| January 14   | Perceptual Organization             | Chapter 2                    |
| January 16   | Depth Perception                    |                              |
| January 21   | Illusions and Constancies           | Chapter 2&3                  |
| January 23   | Color Vision                        |                              |
| January 28   | The Neuropsychology of Vision       | Chapter 1-3                  |
| January 30   | Exam Review                         |                              |
| February 4   | <b>First Exam</b>                   |                              |
| February 6   | Selective Attention                 | Strayer & Drews<br>Chapter 3 |
| February 11  | Divided Attention                   | Chapter 3 & 6                |
| February 13  | Human Factors                       | Chapter 11                   |
| February 18  | Multitasking and Driver Distraction | Strayer & Watson             |
| February 20  | Engineering Psychology              | Readings Set 2               |
| February 25  | Nature and Attention                | Reading Set 1                |
| February 27  | No Class                            |                              |
| March 4      | Exam Review                         |                              |
| March 6      | <b>Second Exam</b>                  |                              |
| March 18     | Varieties of Memory                 | Chapter 4 & 5                |
| March 20     | Short-Term Memory                   | Chapter 6                    |
| March 25     | Episodic Memory                     | Chapter 4 & 5                |
| March 27     | Semantic Memory                     |                              |
| April 1      | Seven Sins of Memory                | Chapter 8                    |
| April 3      | Decision Making                     | Chapter 12                   |
| April 8      | Problem Solving                     | Chapter 11                   |
| April 10     | Psycholinguistics                   | Chapter 9                    |
| April 15     | The Myth of Multitasking            | Chapter 13                   |
| April 17     | Parapsychology                      | Reading Set 3                |
| April 22     | Exam Review                         |                              |
| April 29     | <b>Final Exam</b>                   |                              |

### Additional Reading

#### Reading Set 1 (for February 11<sup>th</sup>)

E. Kwak-Hefferan – Backpacker magazine  
Kaplan 1995

#### Reading Set 2 (February 18<sup>th</sup>)

Set Phasers on Stun  
Rental Car  
In Search of the Lost Cord

#### Reading Set 3 (April 17<sup>th</sup>)

A. Hale – Extraordinary Claims  
E. Loftus – Remembering Dangerously  
M. Gardner – Stone Faces on Mars